



Also a Phone

Nokia 3650

Price: Rs 23,399 **A-**

This new release from Nokia is built on the Symbian operating system version 6.1, just like the Nokia 7650. This is a novel looking phone. The keypad is a bit of a change, and you will have to figure out which key is placed where. A five-way scroll

pad, makes manoeuvring easy. However, one-handed operation is difficult, due to the cramped keypad layout. Even the top two buttons are rather small, making the contact with your fingers a bit difficult. The volume buttons have not been included on the sides.

On the software front, it is exactly the same as the Nokia 7650 except for the addition of the video recorder and the RealOne application. These applications can be downloaded for the Nokia 7650 from Nokia's Web site.

The charm of this phone lies in its price tag, the support for external memory and the 16 MB bundled stick. The backlight colour complements the colour of the phone, for example, the blue phone has a blue backlight. This could pose a problem for the white coloured phone as the readability would suffer in daylight. This is where the Nokia 7650 outsmarts the Nokia 3650, as it has a light sensor which controls the back light of the phone as per the outside surrounding giving perfect readability.

Nokia gives you Bluetooth, however disappoints us by not supporting headset profiles. Nokia Bluetooth only works with Nokia phones or its own accessories, defeating the open standard that is Bluetooth.

The model includes some minor improvements such as tri-band support, external memory support, longer battery life, Web access for XHTML sites and a completely new design.

Overall, the only front that the 3650 beats the 7650 is extending support for external memory, making it ideal for power users.

- + Tri-band, quality camera, external memory, support for viewing XHTML sites, good battery life
- Odd Keypad layout, poor SIM contact management, No cable connectivity.

Nokia 6100

Price: Rs 20,099 **B**

The 6100 phone gives you a 4096 colour display and has the capability of displaying five lines of text. The keypad has a tactile feel—the four-way scroll pad makes flipping through the menus and playing games a pleasure. The designers have wisely used the four-way scroll pad to allow you to access the calendar or the composing message menu by simply pressing the right or left scroll key.

The phone book memory can store up to 300 contacts and 150 messages, and if you so wish, you can also save a varying number of MMS messages, ring tones, images and J2ME application using the 725 KB of memory. You also have the flexibility of saving an image received as a MMS or saving it as a wallpaper.

The phones two pre-installed games, *Chess* and *Bounce*, entertain you, while one Java application called *World Clock*, allows you see the time in various countries all over the world.

We were disappointed with the processing power of the CPU because it takes a reasonable amount of time to open and execute Java programs. The games bundled are average and the screen flickers while playing them. Since the user is expected to pay a handsome price for this handset, one could expect a faster CPU.

The 6100 has a 'Wallet' feature, that allows you to save sensitive data such as credit card information and use it while shopping online. With respect to voice quality, we had a bad experience as there was a consistent drop in the reception where the network signal was weak. In contrast, the Nokia 7650 and the P800 did not face any such problems.

Another strange glitch was seen upon charging—we tried to recharge the completely drained battery, and within 20 minutes the battery indication showed it completely charged. However, when we tried to use it again, the indication bar dropped instantaneously. While this could have been an isolated error pertaining to our particular handset, it would pay to check the battery indicator during a purchase.

The phone is provided with a Pop-Port that can take on an external Nokia camera for snapping pictures.

Overall, a cute looking phone but it needs more features and a faster CPU to justify its price tag.

- + Tri-band, MMS, GPRS and Wallet, good design
- Screen flickers, slow CPU, low memory, no voice-dialling

